

GSM — Governance Succession Module

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

OriginID: OOF-OID-GOA-GCS-GSM-2026-06-25-0001

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™

Architecture Family: Governance Architecture (GOA™)

Operational Layer: Governance Continuity Layer

Governed Space: Governance Succession

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Governance Continuity Governance

Type: Governance Continuity Standard Module

Parent Standard: Governance Continuity Standard (GCS)

Version: 1.0

Status: Canonical · Open Module

Origin Date: 25 June 2026

Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Governance Continuity Standard (GCS)

· Governance Authority Standard (GAS) · Governance Accountability Standard (GAS-A)

· Governance Transparency Standard (GTS) · INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard

AI-Readable: Yes

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition System

Canonical Definition

Governance Succession Module (GSM) defines the structural conditions under which governance authority, governance responsibilities, governance knowledge, governance decision-making capability, and governance legitimacy remain transferable, continuous, traceable, reviewable, governable, and operationally valid throughout succession events.

GSM governs governance succession.

The module establishes the foundational conditions required to ensure that governance remains functional when leadership changes, governance authority is transferred, key governance actors leave, or new governance participants assume responsibility throughout operational reality.

Governance may depend on people.

Governance must not depend solely on people.

GSM governs that continuity through succession.

Module Operational Role

GSM defines the governance-succession layer of GCS.

Its role is to preserve governance continuity during leadership and governance-authority transitions.

Module Operational Space

GSM governs:

- governance succession
- governance authority succession
- governance leadership continuity
- governance responsibility transfer
- governance knowledge continuity
- governance legitimacy preservation
- governance succession traceability
- governance continuity planning

The module applies wherever governance leadership or governance authority may change over time.

Module Function

The module applies wherever systems must preserve:

- legitimate governance succession
- continuous governance authority
- traceable succession history
- reconstructable governance transitions
- governance-valid succession records
- operational governance stability

Its function is to ensure that governance remains operational before, during, and after succession events.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Governance Succession Object

The organization must define which governance environments require governance-succession planning. This may include:

- organizations
 - institutions
 - governments
 - regulatory authorities
 - governance committees
 - corporate governance structures
 - AI governance systems
 - autonomous-agent ecosystems
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- Human-AI governance environments

2. Define Governance Succession Conditions

The system must define the conditions under which governance succession remains valid.

This includes:

- succession requirements
- authority-transfer requirements
- legitimacy requirements
- traceability requirements
- continuity requirements
- governance-valid succession conditions

3. Define Succession Degradation Detection Logic

The system must define how governance-succession failures are identified. This may include:

- missing succession plans
- illegitimate authority transfers
- governance leadership gaps
- knowledge-transfer failures
- continuity interruptions
- governance-invalid succession activities

4. Define Operational Response or Governance Logic

The system must define governance logic for governance-succession failures. Governance response may include:

- succession review
- governance intervention
- authority validation
- knowledge-transfer procedures
- continuity verification
- governance reassessment
- operational invalidation where required

5. Preserve Traceability & Restrict Invalid Conditions

The system must preserve reconstructable traceability of:

- succession events
- authority transfers
- governance reviews
- continuity procedures
- validation activities
- resulting governance states

A governance environment must not remain continuity-valid if materially significant succession activities cannot be reconstructed, reviewed, validated, preserved, or governed.

Use Case 1 — Executive Leadership Succession

Scenario

A Chief Executive Officer retires and governance authority is transferred to a newly appointed executive leadership team.

Application

GSM governs governance succession, authority transfer, leadership continuity, and succession validation.

Result

The organization preserves governance stability, maintains operational continuity, reduces succession risk, and strengthens long-term governance resilience.

Use Case 2 — Human-AI Governance Environment

Scenario

An organization replaces a primary AI governance agent with a more advanced governance system while preserving governance authority, operational rules, accountability, and governance continuity.

Application

GSM governs AI governance succession, authority continuity, knowledge transfer, and Human-AI governance transition.

Result

The organization achieves seamless governance succession, preserves governance trust, minimizes operational disruption, and strengthens long-term Human-AI governance continuity.

Canonical Closing Statement

Governance Succession Module (GSM) defines the structural conditions under which governance authority, governance responsibilities, governance knowledge, governance decision-making capability, and governance legitimacy remain transferable, continuous, traceable, reviewable, governable, and operationally valid throughout succession events.

Governance that cannot survive succession cannot survive time. Governance Succession therefore becomes a foundational condition of trustworthy governance continuity governance.

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Canonical Source

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